

Holy Saints pray for us!

Suggested use of this list: Do a prostration asking each to pray for you.

These are favorite Saints of mine, including the typical list of commemorations for the priest says after the service or in the prayer "Save O God Thy People" (this prayer is said in matins, and other services). They are in an order that developed for me over the years. I always commemorate all of these at the end of a major service such as Divine Liturgy or Vigil.

A suggested prayer is in this basic format: "Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on us," "Most holy Theotokos, save us," "Holy Apostle, Martyr (etc.), pray to God for us!". You may also ask them to pray for the world, or to help you. You may choose to do more than one prostration for some of the names, for instance: do 3 for our Lord Jesus Christ and 3 to the Theotokos and 1 for all the rest. This all depends on the individual.

And with this prayer, make a prostration all the way to the ground and stand back up. You don't need to go fast or slow. You need to pray with intensity. The only rule is intensity, and a repentant and humble spirit.

If you feel tired or feel that you cannot make the prostrations, personal experience has shown that we can always do more than we think we can do. There is also absolutely no rule against doing the prostrations in several sessions, with rest periods. Just remember that we are not trying to pamper our flesh, we are trying to pray with intensity! There will be times when this is not easy. If you are positively unable to do a prostration, do a deep bow slowly and without hurrying.

If you are unable to do many prostrations, do a few. If you are unable to do any prostrations without help, use something to help you get up and down, such as a chair or table.

After doing prostrations to the Holy Ones on this list, we recommend that you also prostrate to a larger group of saints that are former or apparent apostates who were martyred, secret Christians were martyred holy confessors, and those who lived with particular courage and suffered for it. See:

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/saints-pray-for-us+former-apostates-sinners-secret-christians.docx>,

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Lord Jesus Christ, have mercy on us.
Immaculate Lady Theotokos & Ever-
Virgin Mary
Life-creating Cross
Honorable heavenly Bodiless hosts
Guardian Angel
Honorable Glorious Prophet
Forerunner & Baptist John
Holy glorious & all-praised Apostles
Nicholas Archbishop of Myra in Lycia
the Wonderworker
Father Seraphim of Sarov
Nectarios of Pentapolis
John of Shanghai & San Francisco
John of Kronstadt
Jonah of Manchuria

Kosmas Zaire & Grigorou Monastery
Elder Porphyrios of Mt Athos
Elder Paisios of Mt Athos
Fr Silouan of Mount Athos
Fr Sophronius
Mary of Egypt
Matrona the Blessed of Moscow
Patriarch Joseph the All-Comely
Prophet Daniel
Great-Martyr James the Persian
Martyr Timothy of Esphigmenou
Great-martyr & Healer Panteleimon
Maccabean Martyrs, Priest Eliazar, &
Solome
Father Nicephorus the Leper
Monk-martyr James